MARXIST THEORY MADE SIMPLE

Power & Class Struggle in *Lord of the Flies*

How resources, tools, and fear drive the society on Golding's island.

BACKGROUND & CONNECTION

What is Marxist Theory?

The Core Theory

Class & Power: Explains society through wealth, work, and class divisions.

Resource Control: Whoever controls tools and survival needs controls people.

Relation to the Novel

Mini-Society: Golding's island acts as a model of real-world class struggle.

Power Shift: Power shifts from democratic rules to resource monopolies (fire & meat).

SOCIAL HIERARCHY

The Island's Three Classes

Bourgeoisie

Ralph & Piggy: Old democratic authority.

Military Elite

Jack & Hunters: Armed force and meat monopoly.

Proletariat

The Littluns: Powerless, obedient working mass.

RESOURCE POWER

Control of Key Resources

Piggy's Glasses
The primary technology. Whoever holds the glasses controls fire.

The Signal Fire
Shifted from a public tool for rescue to a private weapon for cooking meat.

Food & Meat Monopoly
Jack trades food for total political loyalty from the boys.

IDEOLOGICAL CONTROL

The "Beast" as False Consciousness

Fear keeps the boys obedient.

Jack invents an imaginary threat (The Beast) to make the boys depend on his protection.

Created Enemy

Fear distracts boys from their loss of freedom.

Ritual Rituals

Presents to the Beast enforce blind obedience.

TIMELINE

From Democracy to Total Control

1

Democratic Start

Conch rules and democratic meetings.

→

2

Labor Split

Hunters abandon work to chase meat.

→

3

Tech Stolen

Jack raids Ralph to seize Piggy's glasses.

→

4

Total Power

Conch destroyed; brute force wins.

CLASS CONFLICT

Elimination of Dissent

Piggy (The Intellect)

Represents logic and science. Stolen of his technology and killed when rules break down.

Result: Knowledge silenced by force.

Simon (The Truth)

Discovers the beast is just a dead pilot. Murdered before he can reveal the truth.

Result: Truth destroyed to protect fear.

SUMMARY

Material Power Controls Society

Without fair distribution of resources, democracy fails and those who control food and weapons take total control.